

TESTIMONY BEFORE THE HOUSE STATE GOVERNMENT COMMITTEE ON CONGRESSIONAL
REDISTRICTING

PRESENTED BY

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CHAIRMAN OF THE FRANKLIN COUNTY MPO
CHAIRMAN OF SOUTHAMPTON TOWNSHIP/ FRANKLIN COUNTY

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Chairman Grove and members of the House State Government Committee:

My name is Samuel Cressler and I am the Chairman of Southampton Township/ Franklin County where I have served now for 23 years. I am also the Chairman of the Franklin County MPO and a Board Member for The Pennsylvania State Association of Township Supervisors.

When looking for the best representation scenario for the people I serve and those I represent I see a couple of scenarios that are good and one that is definitely not in our best interest.

Focusing in on just our township, Southampton Township/ Franklin County, is drilling down too far for a district of this size.

My comments are all going to be relating to the political subdivision of Franklin County.

The first positive scenario is including the entire county in an eastern swaying district that may include counties like Cumberland and Adams, etc. The benefit of this redistricting is economic. We share many attributes with those folks like transportation, infrastructure, job growth and with Cumberland, a mutual topography in the Cumberland Valley.

The second positive scenario is including the entire county in a western swaying district that may include counties like Fulton and Bedford, etc. The benefit of this redistricting is societal. We share many attributes with those folks in our enjoyment of a more rural and bucolic environment.

The redistricting scenario that would not be of any benefit to the citizens of Franklin County would be some kind of division of the county. Whether it is split north and south, east and west or even by school district, all of those scenarios would lessen our voice as citizens of Franklin County by reducing the importance of our voter constituency.

In recapping my testimony, the most important need that I wish to convey to the committee is that Franklin County should not be carved up. I feel the best way for our concerns to get to Washington is being in one House District.

I appreciate all the thought and work that the committee is putting into this difficult transition and I hope that my perspective from local leadership will help.